daily consumption of fish is 250-400 g. The beneficial effect of dietary fish is attributed to the fatty acid composition of the fish.

4.3.3 Selection of Fish

Fish that are fresh can be easily identified by the following qualities:

Prawns : Fresh and firm, strong colour, no unpleasant smell.

Scallops : Pinkish white or pale yellow, feel firm, give-off clear liquid.

Clams, oysters and mussels : Tightly closed and heavy for their size, shells should not be cracked.

ω-3 fatty acids protect against cardiovascular disease and are essential for the development and function of brain and prevent inflammation and pain of arthritis.

ACTIVITY - 2

Make a list of the ways in which fish can be used in the menu.

4.4 EGG

4.4.1 Structure and composition of egg

An egg is designed to give protection and food for a developing chick. It is therefore a very nutritious food. There are three main parts: the shell, the white and the yolk.

The shell consists of two parts

1. An outer shell composed mainly of calcium carbonate
2. Two thin inner membranes composed mainly of phosphates

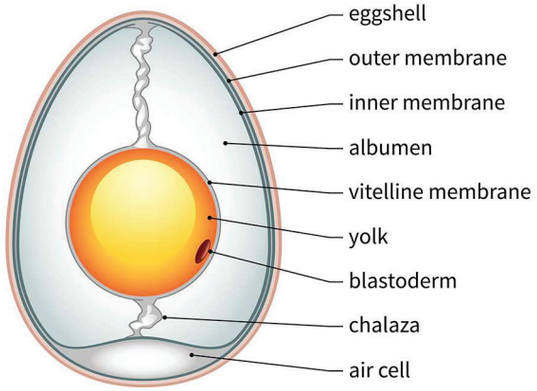


Fig 4.8: Structure of an Egg

The outer shell protects the egg, or the developing chick in a fertilized egg. The shell is porous and contains numerous tiny holes, which enables a chick to breathe. The colour of the shell varies from white to deep brown depending on the breed of the hen.

The two inner membranes lining the shell act as chemical filters to obstruct bacteria which may enter through the porous shell. The two membranes separate to form a small air pocket between them at the rounded end.

The egg white has two distinctly visible layers. The egg white immediately surrounding the yolk is thick and viscous. This is surrounded by a thinner more transparent white.

The egg yolk is anchored to the membranes inside the egg shell by two rope-like structures known as the **chalazae**. These hold the yolk centrally in position. The yolk is separated from the white by a membrane known as the **vitelline membrane**.

The white of the egg (albumin) consists of largely water with no fat or carbohydrate but contains 8-12 percent protein. Different types of proteins are present in egg white

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